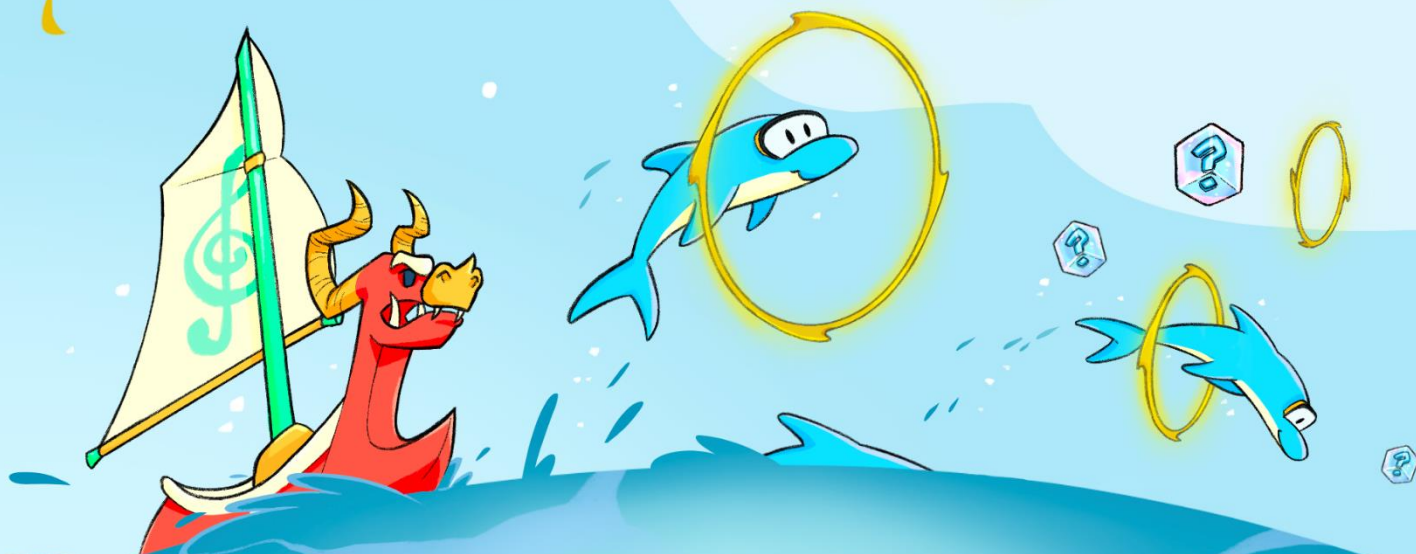


Sweet Suite Summer

with the
London Video Game Orchestra



Saturday 26th July

7:00 pm

The Questors Theatre

Ealing, London

Tickets £16 / Concessions £12



WELCOME

*From the London Video Game Orchestra
and Musical Director, Joe Davies*

What do you hear when you think of the summer?

Island music?

A cool breeze?

The ocean lapping at the shore?

Summertime can be exciting and relaxing, just like our favourite video games. The soundtracks to these games have to capture all of these emotions and more.

From relaxing on the beach to sailing the seas, games and their music reflect our favourite pastimes.

Video game music is more than just background noise. It shapes how we play and experience a game. It makes our palms sweat in a boss fight, soothes us after a long day, and transports us to new worlds. It stays with us long after we've put the controller down.

This evening, we're beyond excited to bring the sounds of summer to life through several medleys and orchestral suites in the halls of the Questors Theatre.

Thank you for being part of this special evening. Sit back, grab your controller (or in this case, your seat), and let's press *PLAY*.

PROGRAMME

THE OUTER WORLDS – Hope

Composer: Justin E. Bell | Arranger: Mattie Bell

FINAL FANTASY VII – Advent: One Winged Angel

Composer: Nobuo Uematsu | Arranger: Andrés Soto | Revisions: Louis James & Chris Carter

FINAL FANTASY VIII – Don't Be Afraid

Composer: Nobuo Uematsu | Arranger: Galen Woltkamp-Moon

THE LEGEND OF ZELDA – Wind Waker Symphonic Suite

Composer: Koji Kondo | Arranger: Andrés Soto

MARIO KART 8 – Dolphin Shoals

Composer: Atsuko Asahi | Arranger: Carlo Pulvirenti, Edoardo Caleffi & Mattie Bell

INTERVAL

ASSASSIN'S CREED 2 – Ezio's Family

Composer: Jesper Kyd | Arranger: James Keirle

ASSASSIN'S CREED 3 – An Uncertain Present & Battle of Breed Hill

Composer: Lorne Balfe | Arranger: Oscar James

FLOWER – Flower Suite

Composer: Vincent Diamante | Arranger: Clive Clifford-Frith

HOLLOW KNIGHT – Hollow Knight Medley

Composer: Christopher Larkin | Arranger: Mattie Bell

THE OUTER WORLDS – Hope

Created by Tim Cain and Leonard Boyarsky of Fallout, The Outer Worlds takes inspiration from space exploration franchises and science fiction. 'Hope' gives a feeling of the vastness of space through sweeping orchestral melodies. This track references the ship The Hope, heading to Halcyon, the furthest colony humanity has established from Earth. Once thought lost, what eventually becomes of her is up to you, the player.

FINAL FANTASY VII – Advent: One Winged Angel

The seventh major instalment of this beloved Japanese role-playing game needs no introduction, representing a massive step forward for console gaming in terms of story, visuals and music. To save the world from an evil corporation, mercenary Cloud Strife teams up with a group of eco-terrorists, one of whom holds the key to the planet's salvation. One Winged Angel is the theme from the final boss battle, which utilises heavyweight percussion and brass, startling contrasts and doom-laden vocals to dramatic effect.

FINAL FANTASY VIII – Don't Be Afraid

Final Fantasy VIII takes players on a journey of love, war, and destiny. The aloof Squall Leonhart is drawn into a conflict that spans time itself, battling the sorceress Edea alongside the elite SeeD forces. Nobuo Uematsu always wanted to work with music. He fell into the world of game music by accident at the age of 25, thinking he would be there for one or two years. It's been over 25 years! He began composing when NES and SNES were the only way to make classical-sounding music. When asked when it was that he felt sound chips had evolved enough to create a true classical sound, he said: "The first time I was able to have the kind of orchestral music I wanted to actually play in the game was from Final Fantasy VIII. For the opening and ending, I actually got an orchestra and choir involved, and was able to record them live."

THE LEGEND OF ZELDA – Wind Waker Symphonic Suite

The tenth instalment in the Legend of Zelda series, the Wind Waker follows Link try to save his sister from the sorcerer Ganon and become embroiled in a struggle for the Triforce, a sacred wish-granting relic. Link sails the ocean, explores islands, and traverses dungeons while controlling the wind with a magic conductor's baton called the Wind Waker.

MARIO KART 8 – Dolphin Shoals

Is there any game that can break a friendship like Mario Kart? Composer Atsuko Asahi is the music lead for the brand new title Mario Kart world, and got her start with Animal Crossing, Pikmin, and Mario Kart 8. The Dolphin Shoals track actually uses three different pieces of music, depending on whether the player is in deep or shallow water or on dry land. The piece featured today is essentially a saxophone concerto, featuring jazzy licks and summertime riffs.

ASSASSIN'S CREED 2 - Ezio's Family

Hack into ancestral memories to travel to 15th century Italy, where the ancient and bitter struggle between the Assassins and the Templars is approaching a turning point. With non-linear gameplay and an exquisite world based on real maps of Renaissance-era Italian cities, playing Assassins Creed II is an experience like no other. This emotive piece, with Gregorian chant-style vocals complemented by flowing flute and clarinet lines, evokes the loyalty and love that bind Ezio and his family – including his descendant, Desmond Miles.



ASSASSIN'S CREED 3 - An Uncertain Present & Battle of Breed Hill

Assassin's Creed 3 continues the legacy of the series, taking inspiration from real-world history. The third instalment takes place in the leadup to the American Revolutionary War; the Battle of Breed hill actually taking place in 1775 Massachusetts.



FLOWER – Flower Suite

Before Journey, there was Flower, a wordless story in which you play a petal floating on the breeze, encouraging other flowers to open at your gentle touch and gaining petals in a joyful stream of colour as you travel through the landscape. In this symphonic treatment we trace the game's story. We begin in a simple, calm, pastoral setting 'Life As A Flower' which builds to 'Sailing On The Wind'. Not everything in life is free-flowing abandon and our journey is curtailed as we find ourselves having to cross the 'Solitary Wasteland'. We struggle onwards towards the light, and end with vibrant, floral wilderness reclaiming of our grey urban milieu in 'The Purification Of The City'.

HOLLOW KNIGHT – Hollow Knight Medley

Hollow Knight is a gorgeously rendered 2D platform action-adventure game, created by Australian indie developers Team Cherry. As the mysterious, nameless Knight, you must confront the disease that turned Hallownest, a once-flourishing kingdom of insect creatures, into a desolate place. This medley is a thrilling ride, culminating in the gothic, dizzying, percussion-heavy battle music for the Nightmare King Grimm. But there are some calmer passages, such as the haunting viola solo that opens the piece and the atmospheric music for the City of Tears.

ABOUT LUGO



The London Video Game Orchestra is a community orchestra founded in the spring of 2019 and is dedicated to making the awe-inspiring world of video game music more accessible to wider audiences.



MUSICIANS

STRINGS

Violin 1

Karyan Au-Yeung
Rebecca Gleave
Lucy Gossip*
Navina Nallamuthu
Jess Prew
Melanie Wong

Violin 2

Henry Chan
Juliet Hutcheson*
Ollie Jonas
Sarah-Jane Service
Catherine Setchfield
Phil Sizer
Bethany Steed

Viola

Natalie Beran†
Andy Coustick-Deal
Lwsi Jones-Angrove
Gemma Kappala-Ramsamy
Yen Ooi
Liv Pearson*

Cello

Sofia Caron
Clive Clifford-Smith
Jamie Flach
Wendy Saunders
Patricia Williams

Double Bass

Peter Selves

WOODWIND

Flute / Piccolo

Nicola Osborne
Jenn Sambridge*
Navina Nallamuthu°

Oboe / Cor Anglais

Gemma Fradin
Nora Wannagat*

Clarinet / Bass Clarinet

Sophie Crump†
Matthew McCarthy*
Alan Wills

Bassoon

Charlotte Barnes*
Maxim Kelly

Saxophone

Carlo Pulvirenti†

BRASS

Horn

Perdi Andrew*
David Aylmer
Xavier Delamotte
David Fisher

Trumpet

Richard Campbell
Arthur Elletson

Trombone

Joe Hammond*
Louis James†
Fred Thorne

Tuba

Lea Hart

RHYTHM AND PERCUSSION

Piano / Keyboard
Richard Osborne

Harp

Ellen Lawford

Guitar

Connor Baxter

Bass Guitar

Oscar Denihan

Percussion

Mattie Bell**
Toby Ellis
Cameron Reed
Sophie Crump°

Lucy Britton†

CONDUCTOR

Joe Davies

**first chair*

**singer*

°for certain pieces only

JOE DAVIES – Musical Director & Conductor

Recently praised for his 'musical brilliance' (Seen and Heard International), Joe Davies is a Conductor working around the UK. He is Assistant Conductor of the English Symphony Orchestra, Musical Director of the UK Proms in the Park Orchestra, Canterbury Symphony Orchestra, Oxford Millennium Orchestra, Leamington Sinfonia, Solway Sinfonia, Cumbria Youth Orchestra, Coventry & Warwickshire Youth Orchestra, and the London Video Game Orchestra, and Artistic Director of the Cumbria Opera Group. Recent and future engagements include the Royal Northern Sinfonia, Orchestra of the Swan, National Schools' Symphony Orchestra, and Sinfonia Smith Square, while previous MD positions include Worcester Philharmonic Orchestra, Midland Concert Orchestra, and Contemporary Music East Midlands (CoMA).

Joe's Opera credits include Don Giovanni, Così fan tutte, Acis and Galatea, Trouble in Tahiti, Dido and Aeneas, and Venus and Adonis with the Cumbria Opera Group, alongside Candide at the Oxford Playhouse and Mansfield Park with Cardiff Opera. Joe was Artistic Director of the Cumbria Opera Festivals 2021 and 2023, involving artists such as Roderick Williams OBE and Joan Rodgers CBE. Joe has conducted premieres of works by Howard Skempton, Alex Ho, and Martin Bussey, while concerto collaborations include Jess Gillam, Laura van der Heijden, Emma Johnson, Xhosa Cole, Kirill Troussov, Benedict Kloeckner, Clare Hammond, and Harry Baker. Joe graduated with a First Class Degree in Music from St Peter's College, Oxford, and studied Orchestral Conducting at the Royal Birmingham Conservatoire, graduating with Distinction, where he studied under Michael Seal. Other training includes the Serena Fenwick Programme with British Youth Opera.

THANK YOU

A huge thank you to The Questors Theatre, our wonderful arrangers, performers, volunteers and ushers, librarian Louis James and the LVGO committee – Gemma Kappala-Ramsamy, Griffin Jenkins, and Louis Lyle – without all of whom this concert would not be possible.

Thank you to Arin Smethurst (@arinsmethurst) for our wonderful poster, Natalie Beran for sourcing gameplay footage, Griffin Jenkins for programme design, and Yen Ooi and Griffin Jenkins for writing the programme notes. Extra thanks to all our players, new and old, who have helped this orchestra grow.

And an extra special thank you to YOU! Without your support, this concert would not be possible. If you're interested in our future projects, play days, or joining the orchestra, check out our website:

<https://lvgo.co.uk>

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@lvgorchestra

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